

01 SMALL TALK

How was your week? Did you talk to anyone new?

Do you usually say hi first, or wait for others to start?

Are you more of a talker or a listener in a group?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

1 ~~"I want to develop myself."~~

✓ "I want to grow professionally."

'develop myself'는 실험실 느낌이라 어색해요. grow, improve, develop my skills로 표현해요.

2 ~~"I resigned my job."~~

✓ "I quit my job."

resign 뒤엔 from이 필요해요. 일상 회화에선 그냥 quit이 자연스러워요.

3 ~~"My company is very welfare."~~

✓ "My company has great benefits."

welfare는 형용사가 아니에요. 회사 복지는 benefits나 perks로 표현해요.

03 오늘의 워업

각 라운드 손가락으로 A 또는 B. 한 라운드마다 한 명 짧게 이유.

WARM-UP

Would You Rather (5분)

1

Know many perfect English phrases but feel too shy to say the first word

VS

Know only a few simple phrases but say hello to anyone with a smile

2

Walk up and join a group of strangers who are already talking

VS

Wait for someone to come and talk to you first

3

Make a small grammar mistake but keep the conversation going

VS

Speak slowly and perfectly but let an awkward silence grow

4

Introduce yourself in one short, easy sentence

VS

Introduce yourself in a long, impressive sentence you memorized

CAREER · MAIN DISCUSSION

Networking English — Better Phrases or More Courage?

🇰🇷 BACKGROUND

네트워킹 영어는 좋은 표현을 아는 것만으로 해결되지 않아요. 처음 말을 거는 용기, 어색한 침묵을 넘기는 힘, 상대방에게 부담스럽지 않게 나를 소개하는 감각이 같이 필요해요. 표현을 많이 외워도 막상 행사장에서 눈이 마주치면 말이 안 나올 수 있고, 반대로 간단한 표현만 있어도 태도가 편하면 대화가 이어질 수 있어요. 실력은 문장과 용기 사이에서 만들어져요.

📖 READ BEFORE WE TALK

Networking English is not only about having better phrases. Useful expressions help, but the hardest part is often starting the conversation, keeping it warm, and introducing yourself without sounding stiff. A person may know polished sentences and still freeze in the room. Another person may use simple English but create a comfortable mood through curiosity and confidence. Networking also needs listening, follow-up questions, and knowing when to end the conversation naturally. The real skill is a mix of language and social courage. Good English opens the door, but courage helps someone actually walk through it.

💡 WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

break the ice — 어색한 분위기를 풀다

make the first move — 먼저 말을 걸다

fill the silence — 침묵을 메우다

freeze up — 얼어붙어 말이 안 나오다

small talk — 가벼운 잡담

a follow-up question — 이어지는 후속 질문

🗣️ TRY THESE PHRASES

Honestly, courage is my weak point — I know the phrases, but ____.

It really comes down to ____ for me, because ____.

The harder part for me is ____, mainly because ____.

Compared to keeping it going, starting feels ____ to me.

⚡ EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'work the room' or a 'find one person and stick with them' networker at events?
- 2 When was the last time you exchanged contact info with someone new — and did you ever follow up?
- 3 Quick — if you had to pick: weather, work, or weekend plans — what's your go-to small talk opener with someone new?
- 4 On a scale of 1 to 5, how often do you go to events where you have to talk to strangers?

🗣️ MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. In networking, do you need better phrases or more courage? Which one is your weak point?

↳ *Honestly, courage is my weak point — I know the phrases, but ____.*

↳ *It really comes down to ____ for me, because ____.*

Q2. What is harder for you — starting a conversation or keeping it going? Why?

↳ *The harder part for me is ____, mainly because ____.*

↳ *Compared to keeping it going, starting feels ____ to me.*

Q3. What makes a self-introduction sound too stiff or rehearsed? How do you fix it?

↳ *It sounds too stiff when ____, so what I do is ____.*

↳ *The thing is, a good intro should feel ____, not ____.*

Q4. How do you end a conversation politely, without it feeling awkward?

↳ *What works for me is ____ before I leave.*

↳ *Most of the time, I end it by ____ so it doesn't feel awkward.*

Q5. Career choices often mix growth and stability. What kind of risk would feel worth it for you?

↳ *I'd say a risk is worth it when ____, because ____.*

↳ *I lean more toward ____ than ____, since ____.*